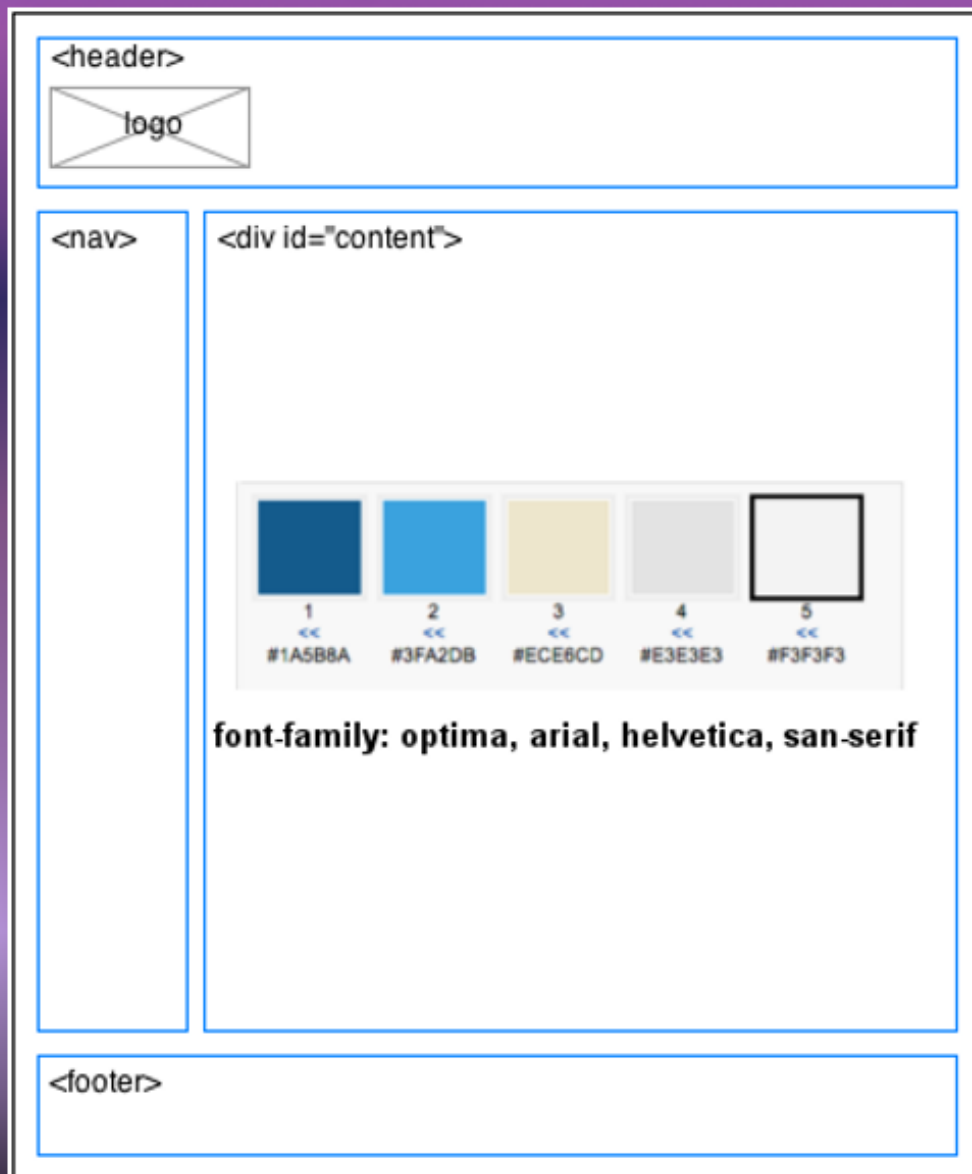


Project: CSS Specifications



Give Your Website Personality

You have a web page with headings and text and a graphic image or two. But it looks well, boring.

Ahh, but now you know about CSS and are ready to add some personality to your web pages.

This project will demonstrate the following:

- I can visualize and draw out a sketch showing my ideas for a simple page layout.
- I have a color scheme and know how to use it on my web pages.
- I can use the hex color codes with my CSS for exact color matches.
- I can change the fonts (and font-sizes) on my web pages.
- I can add borders and padding around text and other objects on the page.
- I know the difference between `<div>` and `<span>` and can use them correctly on my web pages.
- I know when to use the naming attributes `class=" "` and `id=" "`.
- I can organize my web pages into 2 and 3 column layouts using CSS.
- I know how to use a single CSS file to style all my web pages on a site. I also know how to use embedded and inline CSS styles that will override what is in the external stylesheet file.

File Management

1. Create a folder named prjCSS (Do not use a file extension on your folders!) - This is the folder that you will zip up and submit to your instructor.
2. Inside this folder include a file named: **index.html** and a sub-folder named: **graphic**. All graphic files for this project will be stored in this sub-folder.
3. Include **wireFrame.png** inside the graphic folder.

Feel free to use the files from Project: Web Page as a starting point for this project.

Make a copy and save them in this new project.

Beware of double extensions on your file names!

Make sure your files extensions are all displaying when setting up these files! Don't know how? Go back through the Learning Activities to learn how. Or, use Google: "the name of your Operating System" "show file extensions"

Specifications

Feel free to make a copy of **Project: Web Page** and use it as a starting point for this project.

Visualize and draw a sketch of your web page.

Based on what you have learned by doing the Learning Activities for this module, sketch out a drawing showing the various areas on your page. You can use either a 2-column or 3-column layout. (Tip: Keep it simple!)

The drawing can either be done using pencil and paper or else using a drawing program on your computer.

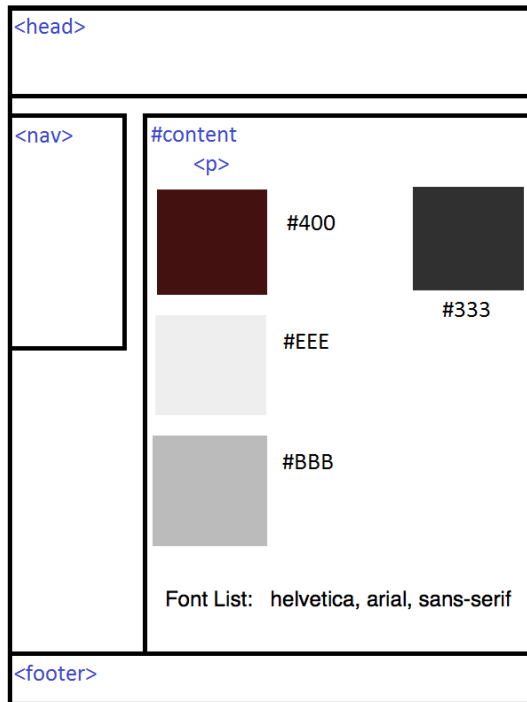
Mark each section of the page with the HTML 5 element you plan to use for that section. For example: `#content` for the section of the page holding the main content. `<nav>` for the navigational block.

Set up a color scheme for your web site using one of the web sites you discovered as you did the Learning Activities for this module. Take a screen shot of the colors you plan to use showing the color swatches and their hex codes.

Determine the font to be used on the page. Include at least three alternate fonts in case the main one specified is not available on an end-user's computer.

Name this file: **wireFrame.png**

Here is an example of what one student did for a layout diagram:



Style your web page using an external style sheet.

1. Create an external style sheet named `prjCSS.css` and save it in the same folder as your web page.
2. Use the correct HTML element to connect the external style sheet to the `index.html` file.
3. Only use the hex colors (plus white and black) listed on your color scheme.
4. Include CSS code for at least three HTML selectors. For example `body`, `h1`, `h2`, `p`, `img`.
5. Change the background color of the web page and/or individual objects on the page.
6. Change the font using at least three alternatives in case the user does not have the actual font the design calls for.
7. Use padding, margins, and borders to improve the readability of the page.

Use `<span>` to style a unique piece of in-line text. Name this element using the `id=""` attribute.

Utilize a `<span>` element on the page demonstrating that you know the difference between a `<span>` and a `<div>`.

Add the proper CSS selector to the external stylesheet for this `<span>` element.

Use `<div>` and the new HTML 5 elements to create a 2 or 3 column layout.

Use at least one `<div>` elements and other HTML 5 elements to create the page layout based on your sketches.

Use the `class=""` attribute to style multiple objects.

For example you might want to style several `<p>` different from the rest of the page. Name these particular `<p>` using the `class=""` attribute.

Or maybe you have multiple `<span>` elements and you want them all to have the same styling.

Add the appropriate CSS selector and properties in the external style sheet for this class.

Use at least one embedded CSS selector to override the more general CSS in the external file.

For example, if the external file makes all `<h2>` text dark blue, create an embedded `h2` selector that will override this and make them green.

Use in-line CSS to override the both the external and the embedded CSS code.

For example, use in-line CSS to change just one `<h2>` element text to red.

Demonstrate Your Problem Solving Skills

At the bottom of the page, so that the user can read them, list at least two problems you encountered doing this project, as well as how you solved them.

Create a Video

Using Screencast-o-Matic create a video following this script.
Please try to keep the video under 3 minutes.

Before you start the video have the following three applications open:

1. Your index.html and prjCSS.css files open in a text editor
2. A view of your wireframe.png. The hex codes must be readable.
3. A view of the index.html in a browser.

Please follow this script in order:

(You might want to jot some prompts down to help you stay on track.)

1. Show the page layout and color scheme.
2. Show the finished web page in a browser.
3. Show the CSS code in your external style sheet.
4. Point out the selector that is over-ridden by the CSS in the embedded code on the HTML file itself.
5. Show the embedded code in the web page that overrides the general CSS located in the external style sheet.
6. Show the in-line code that overrides all the other CSS for that particular object.
7. Show the element and discuss how is different from <div>.
8. Show the <div> elements and how you uses them on the page.
9. Discuss the difference between the id=" " naming attribute and the class=" " naming attribute.

Submit to D2L

1. Zip up the folder named prjCSS (containing all your files and sub-folders) and submit to D2L.
2. In the notes of this drop box add the link to your Screencast-O-Matic video. (Copy and paste the URL-web address from Screencast-O-Matic

into the notes text area in D2L)

Notes & FAQ

1. All folder and file names must be as specified. UPPER/lowercase matter. All filenames and folders must follow the naming conventions.
 - Always start with a lower case letter.
 - No spaces and no underlines "_".
 - useCamelCaseForReadability
 - Don't use plurals.
 - File extensions should be lower case.
2. Make sure your text editor changes all TABs to three spaces. Points will be taken if any TABS are found in the code. Do a Google search to learn how to view the visible spaces for the editor you are using.
3. Keep your backgrounds light and text colors dark. Light colored text against dark backgrounds for paragraph text is not acceptable for this project.

Frequently Asked Questions

My whole page is white! Nothing is showing at all. What should I do?

Validate your HTML code. Most likely you are missing a `</style>` element or it is not nested properly inside the `<head>` element.

What's the difference between `class=" "` and `id=" "`?

The `class=" "` attribute is used to name things that may repeat on the page. For example, there may be several `<p>` elements that should be styled the same. Use the `class=" "` for those. Or there may be several `<img />` elements that need special CSS styling.

The CSS code for `class=" "` is a period `."`

The `id=" "` attribute is used to name unique things that will only appear once on the page.

The CSS code for `id=" "` is a hash mark `"#"`

What's the difference between `<span>` and `<div>`?

Go back and review the Tutorial: Introduction to CSS. There is a section on the `<span>` element showing how the `class=" "` attribute is used for repeating objects.

How does `class=" "`, `id=" "`, `<span>` and `<div>` all fit together? I have them all mushed up inside my head.

`<span>` and `<div>` are HTML markers. They let you mark out specific blocks on the page.

`id` and `class` are name tags. They are used to name the `<span>` or `<div>` markers so you can style them using CSS.

A `<span>` or `<div>` can be named using either an `id=" "` or a `class=" "` depending on if the object will be unique on the page (then use `id=" "`) or part of a group of items to be styled (then used `class=" "`).

The Basics of Web Design textbook by Terry Felke-Morris has some good examples of `class=" "` and `id=" "` on pages 114-115.

Look on pages 116-117 there's a discussion on using the `<span>` element.

I'm not clear on the difference between External, Embedded, and In-Line CSS. Can you help me with that?

Sure! I wrote the Tutorial: 3 Ways to Use CSS just for you. It is one of the last Learning Activities in the Module: CSS.

The Basics of Web Design textbook by Terry Felke-Morris also covers this very well. Check out pages 108-113. On page 118 Terry has a practice lab showing how to convert embedded CSS (the code inside the `<style>` element)

into an external style sheet.

How do I make certain my text editor is changing all TABS into three spaces automatically?

If you are using Notepad++ you will find instructions on how to set up the editor so it always changes TAB characters into 3 spaces.

Look in the Module: Tools under the Learning Activity: Install a text editor on your flash drive. There is a screen shot there showing how to change this setting.

If you are using another text editor do a Google search for: <name of the text editor> change TAB to spaces

To see if you have any TABs in a document use View/Show Symbol/Show All Characters or View/Show Symbol/Show White Space and Tab.

If you are using another text editor do a Google search for: <name of the text editor> show spaces

I didn't use the TAB key but, I still have TABS in my code. Why is that?

Most text editors automatically indent your code using the TAB character. Just by hitting ENTER you may be introducing TABS into your document. (That is why you want to change the setting to automatically change all TABs to 3 spaces.)

If you do have TABs in your document simply use CTRL F (Find) and search for the TAB character and replace it with three spaces. On many systems the /t is the same as hitting the TAB key.

Grading Checklist

Total Points Possible: 50 points

10 points - Page Layout (wireFrame.png)

- Each section marked with HTML 5 element or <div> name.
- Color scheme with **readable** hex color codes and color swatches
- Font list of at least 3 fonts.

10 points - External Style Sheet

- Named **prjCSS.css**
- index.html and **prjCSS.css** linked together correctly
- At least three HTML selectors
- Change background color
- Change text color
- Change font with alternatives
- Padding, margins, and borders

5 points - Embedded CSS and In-line CSS

- Demonstrate overriding general CSS selector (from external page) using embedded code on web page itself.
- Demonstrate overriding embedded code using in-line style for a particular object.

5 points - Use appropriately.

5 points - Use <div> appropriately.

5 points - Use id=" " attribute correctly and write a valid CSS selector for the id.

5 points - Use class=" " attribute correctly and write a valid CSS selector for the class.

5 points - Demonstrate Your Problem Solving Skills

At the bottom of the page, list at least two problems you encountered doing

this project as well as how you solved them.

Points will be taken off for:

- File and folder names are different than the names that are specified.
- HTML errors when page is validated.
- Not following naming conventions.
- Misspelled words, poor grammar, improper capitalization in the content of the page. (In doubt? Use <http://www.paperrater.com/>)
- Files contain TABs instead of 3 spaces. (See the [FAQ](#) in this document to learn how to check your files for TAB characters).

Last update: 11/08/2014